# Damien Smith

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## PROFILE

Software engineer with four years across early-stage startups and fintech, most recently as Head of Product Engineering. Joined as one of the first two engineers at a startup founded by ex-Amazon engineering leaders and grew into the engineering lead of its AI agent platform. Strongest in TypeScript, Node.js and AWS, with hands-on agent tooling work: connector design, context management and workflow orchestration. Uses Claude Code daily and built Clance, a macOS hotkey overlay and agent management application for it. Looking for a hands-on engineering role on a product team to grow with.

## EXPERIENCE

### Head of Product Engineering — Console One
Apr 2024 – Present

*Bootstrapped startup founded by ex-Amazon engineering leaders, building agent orchestration and developer tools across three products: Console One, StoryLens and Shared Office. Funded in part through SR&ED research grants, with a team of up to eight engineers. Software Engineer (Apr – Oct 2024), promoted to Head of Product Engineering (Nov 2024).*

*Shared Office – 2026*

- A local-first workspace that tracked a person's work and AI agents and exposed it to models over MCP, so a team could see one feed.
- Built the account layer with auth, per-user vaults, settings and payments, and an admin dashboard for usage and rate limits.

*StoryLens - 2025 – Present*

- Led engineering and was the primary contributor for StoryLens, a local-first, LLM-provider-agnostic desktop workspace for macOS and Windows: connect your tools once, ask in plain English, and get reports saved to a searchable local library or run on a schedule. Rolled out to startups in January 2026 through a B2B sales pipeline.
- Designed a stateful agent workflow engine with adaptive context management: tools start compressed, and the agent inspects, dismisses and expands them while results live in an external workspace. Let an LLM work across 100+ tools without loading every schema into each prompt.
- Built the toolset compiler and connector service: one declarative JSON definition per endpoint compiles into the LLM tool, its secrets, description, install form and HTTP request, with credentials injected at call time so the model never sees a token. 107 tools across 12 integrations at roughly one connector a week. Introduced MCP to the company with a first client prototype.
- Built human-in-the-loop approvals: agent workflows pause on tools that need sign-off and resume when the user approves or rejects.
- Owned QA and dev ops: AWS stacks, Apple notarization and Windows signing, and server logic moved to Lambda with S3 presigned URLs so no secrets shipped in the client. Built a custom B+Tree local store in TypeScript for long keys and range scans, later retired for SQLite when requirements changed.

*Console One IDE - 2024 – 2025*

- A browser IDE for writing full-stack apps and deploying them to AWS in one click, with collaborative editing and version control built in. Ran on a self-hosted kernel that built and deployed its own source. Added AI: prompt-to-project, a chat pane, and GPT suggestions shown as a merge you accept or reject. Used in an April 2024 coding bootcamp program.
- Acting engineering lead for four engineering interns: sprint planning, task breakdown, daily check-ins, technical direction and code review, then formalized as Head of Product Engineering.
- Owned the Lambda deployer and prototyped one-click LLM auto-repair: runtime logs and source go to the model, and the fixed file is committed and redeployed.
- Built the WebSocket server and client: a Redis-backed topic bus that streamed build logs, deploys and LLM output to the editor, designed as the duplex channel for Lambda tasks to message each other without a central orchestrator. Later rebuilt it on Redis pub/sub and Streams and open-sourced it.
- Moved the version-control graph from Neo4j to Redis, cutting latency and hosting cost.

### Software Engineer Intern — Moves Financial
Aug 2022 – Sep 2023

- Full-stack on a fintech platform serving thousands of gig workers. Worked on the authentication service, introduced biometric login, and worked directly with vendors to integrate their APIs.
- Built earnings tracking and a rewards system with goal setting and notifications; owned projects from planning through deployment.

### Software Developer — Console One
May 2021 – Aug 2022

*One of the first two engineers; built the company's first prototype, on the idea that cloud configuration, not code, was the bottleneck in building software. Stayed on part-time through the school year.*

- Prototyped a browser-based IDE with continuous version control and fast AWS Lambda deploys; scaffolded the React/Redux frontend and API layers and acted as engineering liaison between management and contributors.
- Built multiplayer version control for mixed-format documents on stateless Lambdas (delta encoding, lineage tracking, a snapshot every ~10 versions to bound rebuilds) after CRDT libraries of the time couldn't give queryable, attributable history there.

## EDUCATION

**Queen's University** — B.A.Sc., Computer Engineering
May 2024

Academic Excellence Scholarship, Dean's List. Teaching Assistant, Computer Programming (Sep 2021 – Jan 2022).

## SKILLS

**Languages:** TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · Java · C++ · Go | **Spoken:** English (native) · French (fluent) · Spanish (intermediate)
**Systems & AI:** LLM and agent orchestration · connector design · context management · MCP · REST, WebSockets, GraphQL
**Stack:** Node.js · React · React Native · Electron · AWS (Lambda, EC2, S3) · MongoDB · Redis · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Neo4j · Docker · CI/CD